CABERGOLINE

Twice weekly

Valvular fibrosis (high dose)

CHEMICAL NAME (8β)-N-[3-(dimethylamino)propyl]-N-(ethylcarbamoyl)-6-(prop-2-en-1-yl)ergoline-8-carboxamide

CLASS Dopamine D2 receptor agonist (ergot derivative)

TRADE NAMES Dostinex · Cabaser · Caberlin

THERAPEUTIC USES / INDICATIONS

- Hyperprolactinaemia and prolactinomas.
- Inhibition or suppression of lactation (stillbirth, miscarriage, HIV-positive mothers).
- Acromegaly (adjunct); Parkinson's disease (rarely now).

ADMINISTRATION

- **PO** with food (reduces nausea).
- Lactation prevention: single dose on first day postpartum.

DOSAGES

- **Prevent lactation:** 1 mg single dose within 24 h of delivery.
- **Suppress established lactation:** 250 mcg every 12 h for 2 days.
- **Hyperprolactinaemia:** 500 mcg weekly (single or 2 doses), increase monthly; usual 1 mg weekly (max 4.5 mg/week).

PHARMACOKINETICS

- **Onset:** prolactin falls within 3 h. **Duration:** up to 14–21 days (long-acting).
- Metabolised in liver.
- Excreted in faeces. **t½:** 63–69 h.

PHARMACODYNAMICS

- Stimulates **D2 receptors** on pituitary lactotrophs → strong ↓ prolactin secretion; shrinks prolactinomas.

SIDE & ADVERSE EFFECTS

SIDE EFFECTS (COMMON)

- Nausea, dizziness, headache.
- Postural hypotension.
- Fatigue, constipation.

ADVERSE EFFECTS (SERIOUS)

- Cardiac valvulopathy, pericardial/pulmonary/retroperitoneal fibrosis (long-term, high doses).
- Impulse-control disorders (gambling, hypersexuality).
- Psychosis; sudden sleep onset.

CONTRAINDICATIONS & CAUTIONS

- History of fibrotic disorders, cardiac valvulopathy (long-term use).
- Pre-eclampsia, uncontrolled postpartum hypertension.
- Hypersensitivity to ergot derivatives; severe hepatic impairment.
- Psychosis history.

KEY INTERACTIONS

- **Antipsychotics, metoclopramide:** antagonism.
- **Macrolides:** ↑ levels.
- **Antihypertensives:** ↑ hypotension.

NURSING MANAGEMENT

- Postpartum: check BP before and after (avoid in pre-eclampsia); emotional support after loss.
- Monitor postural BP.
- Long-term: echocardiogram at baseline and periodically.
- Monitor prolactin levels.

PATIENT EDUCATION

- Take with food.
- Rise slowly; report dizziness or fainting.
- Report breathlessness, persistent cough, chest pain, swelling (fibrosis).
- Report compulsive behaviours (gambling, shopping).

KEY POINTS

- Long-acting D2 agonist; lowers prolactin.
- Prolactinoma: twice-weekly dosing.
- 1 mg single dose to prevent lactation.
- Avoid in pre-eclampsia; valve fibrosis long-term.

SOURCES CHECKED **[662]** Cabergoline 0.5mg tablets (UK SmPC) **[663]** Cabergoline, oral (US label) **[664]** Cabergoline, oral (US label, A-S Medication Solutions)

Full references p. 432–457